



AI Beer

The IntelligentX beer is brewed by AI, that takes feedback from its customers to continuously improve the product.
<https://dgit.in/sep18-19-1>

a panel on "Pathways to Banning Fully Autonomous Weapons". The purpose of the discussion was to make sure that in the future, countries and their militaries do not develop or produce any lethal autonomous weapons systems or LAWS. Among the many moral concerns raised, was giving the ability of making life and death decisions to robots on the battlefield. However, a number of governments and private corporations all around the world are actively developing weapons systems with varying degrees of autonomy. More information about this topic is available here: <https://dgit.in/laws>.

ENGINES OF HORROR

DeepDream is a neural network that enhances patterns within an image where none exist. The phenomenon is known as pareidolia, which is why humans see faces in objects. Some of the resulting overprocessed images can only be described as high octane nightmare fuel.

A team at MIT wanted to investigate if machines could be taught to scare humans. The result was the Nightmare Machine – which does two things. It makes creepy faces, and with the help of humans, learns to make them even more creepier. The other thing it does is apply a variety of horror movie styles to images. The team used famous landmarks from around the world to demonstrate this capability. The styles themselves are enough to freak out the weak hearted – haunted house, fright night, slaughter house, toxic city, ghost town, tentacle monster and alien invasion.

An experimental AI by Cris Valenzuela, interprets text strings as images. This neural network is like the reverse of the CaptionBot by Microsoft. These are not images picked from the internet, but images that the neural network produces, in real time, letter by letter, as you type. The images are at worst very abstract, and at best abominations that are likely to make your hair stand on end. If you have the nerve for it, you can check it out here: <https://dgit.in/horrorai>.

UNEXPECTED INNOVATIONS

In 1994, Karl Sims created simulated virtual creatures made up of simple 3D blocks and neural networks as brains which applied different degrees of twisting forces to the blocks. The intention was to make the simulated animals try to learn to walk over a particular distance. Instead of growing limbs or crawling through the simulated ground, the creatures just evolved to be very tall and fell over. Google's DeepMind AI was also used to teach various kinds of bots – human and spider like – to walk, run and jump. The neural networks learned to walk and jump alright, but the movement was nothing like what a real human could possibly do. The resulting gait looked like the virtual agent was possessed by a demon. The arms swung around wildly to keep the balance, while the legs moved in exaggerated, jerky steps. Still, despite how silly the movement looks, DeepMind actually figured out the problem presented to it.

In another experiment, a computer scientist collaborated with a team of physicists to find low energy carbon structures. The algorithm threw up a low energy model that was too good to be true, and it was. All the carbon atoms were in the same position in space. The program was patched to prevent the atoms from being in a superposition, when the algorithm threw up another solution that clearly violated the laws of physics. At this point, the participants gave up on the collaboration as they were more interested in finding actual solutions, rather than discovering edge cases.

Another neural network learned to outsmart the hardware itself. The program had to provide an input for a five in a row tic-tac-toe game, on an infinite board. You probably see that infinity is the problem here. The oversmart machine learned that if an input was provided very far away from the used up cells on the board, the computer would crash, forfeiting the match, and allowing the AI to win. This neural network learned to exploit the computer instead of learning to win. 



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